

DAREN

Ottawa, ON, Canada

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Professional Objective

AI Software Development student at Algonquin College (Ottawa), transitioning from over 10 years as a deck officer in the international merchant marine. Background defined by operational rigour, multicultural team leadership and bilingual proficiency. Winner of the 1st prize at the College La Cite Computer Science Challenge 2026. I am looking to leverage this dual expertise to contribute to the development of innovative software solutions within a dynamic team.

Technical Skills

- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, HTML5, CSS3
 - **Backend:** Express 5, Node.js, Prisma, FastAPI, REST API
 - **Mobile:** .NET MAUI / C#, SwiftUI, Kotlin / Android
 - **Databases:** (SQL): PostgreSQL, SQLite; (NoSQL): MongoDB, Cassandra; Redis
 - **Introduction to AI:** Python, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow (introductory level)
 - **Tools:** Git, GitHub, VS Code, Vite, Electron, Figma
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Methods & Collaboration

- Apply Agile and Scrum methodologies in team-based projects.
 - Use Jira for backlog management and sprint tracking.
 - Collaborate using Git and GitHub (branching, pull requests, code reviews).
 - Communicate professionally in both of Canada's official languages (French and English).
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Key Skills

- Design and develop web, mobile and desktop applications end to end.
 - Analyze functional requirements and propose suitable software architectures.
 - Solve complex problems and make decisions under pressure.
 - Learn autonomously and strive for continuous improvement.
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Projects

ProfMatchAI, 1st Prize, College La Cite Computer Science Challenge 2026

- Develop an AI-powered platform for assigning professors to courses with compatibility scoring and natural language justifications.
- Collaborate in a team of 4 (2 dev + 2 AI) using a Next.js, Express 5, Prisma, FastAPI and Python stack.

Personal Project - HEDNAI, 2025 - Present

Ongoing project in the field of maritime technology and artificial intelligence.

- Research and design technology-driven solutions to address real-world maritime challenges.
- Build web applications and software using React, TypeScript, Node.js and various AI technologies.

- Leverage over 10 years of hands-on merchant marine experience to identify operational pain points and shape the solutions being developed.

Karibou Market, Online Marketplace (capstone project, College La Cite)

- Build a marketplace for African grocery stores in the Ottawa-Gatineau area with JWT authentication, Redis caching and Cypress end-to-end testing.
- Use Next.js, Express 5, MongoDB and Cloudinary for image management.

FleetLog, Maritime Fleet Management Software (in design)

- Design an offline-first desktop application for small maritime companies using Electron, React, Drizzle/SQLite and Prisma/PostgreSQL synchronization.

Other academic projects: BiblioKowazo, GeoSpot, RefugeAnimo, AutoVitrine - .NET MAUI/C#, SwiftUI and Kotlin applications.

Full portfolio: hednai.com

Education

Algonquin College, Ottawa, ON

Artificial Intelligence Software Development Sept 2026 - Apr 2027

Ontario College Graduate Certificate

College La Cite, Ottawa, ON

Diploma in Computer Programming May 2025 - Aug 2026

Cumulative Weighted GPA: 4.16

Regional Academy of Marine Sciences and Technologies, Abidjan, Cote d'Ivoire

Master Mariner (ships of any tonnage) April 2023

Regional Academy of Marine Sciences and Technologies, Abidjan, Cote d'Ivoire

Chief Mate (ships of any tonnage) Sept 2011

Previous Experience

Senior Deck Officer, International Merchant Marine | 2011 - 2024

- Lead multicultural crews and train junior officers on oil tankers, gas carriers and chemical tankers.
- Contribute to the successful completion of oil major inspections (Total, Shell, Cepsa).
- Obtain a promotion through an exceptional waiver from the French Maritime Authorities.
- Work exclusively in English in international environments (USA, Spain, France, Africa).

(Full details of maritime career available upon request)

Languages

- French: native speaker.
 - English: professional working proficiency (sole working language for over 10 years at sea).
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Awards & Distinctions

- 1st Prize, College La Cite Computer Science Challenge 2026 (ProfMatchAI project).
- Exceptional waiver from the French Maritime Authorities to serve as Chief Mate on a French-flagged vessel.